

HIV Testing



Presented by: Aldean A. Williams
Programme Officer HIV
HIV/STI/TB Unit

Ministry of Health and Wellness
Email: Aldean.Williams@moh.gov.jm.com

Presentation Overview

PREVENTION



HIV Self Testing
(HIVST)

Provider Initiated
Testing and
Counselling (PITC)

HIV Self Testing (HIVST)

- HIV self-testing allows patients to take an HIV test and find out their results in their own home or other private locations.
- The availability of HIV self-tests in the Jamaica can help increase awareness of HIV infection for people who wouldn't otherwise get an HIV test.
- HIV Self Testing can be used for PrEP initiation, continuation, and restarting.
- HIV Self Testing will contribute to the global target by reaching first-time testers, as well as by creating demand for and enabling more persons to have a HIV test.



HIV Self Testing (HIVST)



People can test wherever and whenever they want

HIV self-testing empowers people to find out their HIV status wherever and whenever they want. Since it is easy, quick and private, people may be encouraged to take a test earlier than they would if they had to visit a health facility, potentially bringing an earlier diagnosis. Any HIV-positive result must, however, be followed up with a second test by a health-care provider to confirm the result and get linked to appropriate prevention, treatment and care.



Reducing stigma

Fear of stigma deters many people from accessing HIV testing services. HIV self-testing gives people the freedom to test anonymously, confidentially and privately.



HIV self-testing reaches people who are left behind

HIV self-testing has been shown to reach people who would not otherwise be reached by testing services. Men, young people and members of key populations—gay men and other men who have sex with men, sex workers, transgender people, people who inject drugs, prisoners and other incarcerated people and migrants—are reached in greater numbers where self-testing has been rolled out.



Relieving the burden at health-care centres

By offering self-test kits at busy health-care centres where everyone should be tested, but resources may be lacking, only people who test positive, or people with particular concerns, need to be seen by staff in the HIV testing services at the clinic.



No coercion

With increases in the availability of HIV self-testing comes the real risk of coercion. No one—not doctors, partners, family members, employers or anyone else—should force you to take a test. HIV testing should always be voluntary and with consent.



On treatment? Don't self-test

Effective HIV treatment reduces the level of HIV in the blood to undetectable levels. An HIV self-test, or any other HIV test, taken while someone is on treatment could come up as negative even though the person is still HIV-positive. People should never self-test while on HIV treatment.



Counselling is important

HIV testing should always be accompanied by counselling. People who self-test should always be informed of the various opportunities for counselling, whether it is by phone, online, by a pharmacist or in any other acceptable way.



Be aware of other sexually transmitted infections

HIV self-tests give results only for HIV. People who take an HIV self-test should be made aware that they could be living with, and therefore be tested for, other sexually transmitted infections.



Reaching the hard to reach

Hard-to-reach people can be better reached with self-testing. Women at an antenatal clinic or people from key populations who are visiting health-care facilities can collect self-testing kits and offer them to their partners.

HIV Self Testing (HIVST)

Inclusion

- ❖ Those who are 16 years old and able to provide verbal informed consent
- ❖ First-time testers or have not tested in the last 12 months
- ❖ Persons reporting high risk behavior
- ❖ Partners of persons reporting high-risk behavior
- ❖ Persons not on ART

Exclusion

- ❖ On ART
- ❖ Knows HIV positive
- ❖ Persons under the age of 16

HIVST Locations

Know your HIV Status
with a **Self-Test Kit**

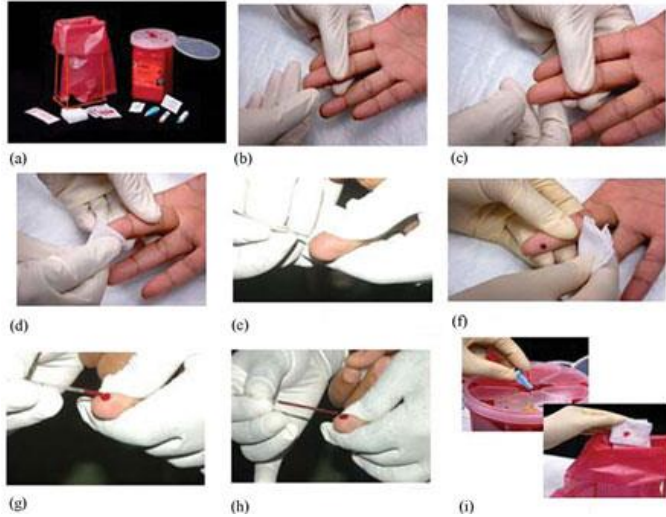
Get a **Free HIV Self-Test Kit, today!**



✓ JN+
✓ ASHE
✓ JASL (Kingston, St. Ann, Montego Bay)
✓ EVE for Life (Kingston, St. Ann, Montego Bay)
✓ Children First Agency
✓ Children of Faith
✓ NCDA
✓ Jamaica Family Planning Association (St. Ann & Kingston)
✓ CHARES
✓ Teen Hub

 **SHOW ME ALL LOCATIONS**

Provider Initiated Testing and Counseling (PITC)



What is PITC?

- Provider Initiated Testing and Counseling.
- Routinely recommended by health care providers to persons attending health care facilities as a standard component of medical care.
- With this approach, an HIV test is recommended for all patients whose clinical presentation might result from underlying HIV infection or as a standard part of medical care for all patients attending health facilities in areas of high HIV prevalence.

PITC Objectives

The provider-initiated model has the potential to result in:

- Higher uptake of HIV testing
- Increased identification of HIV positive cases
- medical practitioners being able to appropriately treat PLHIV earlier
- Reduction in incidences of opportunistic infections among PLHIV (as a result of earlier detection and treatment)

Who is responsible to do PITC?

PITC incorporates a wide range of staff members (Providers), these include but are not limited to:

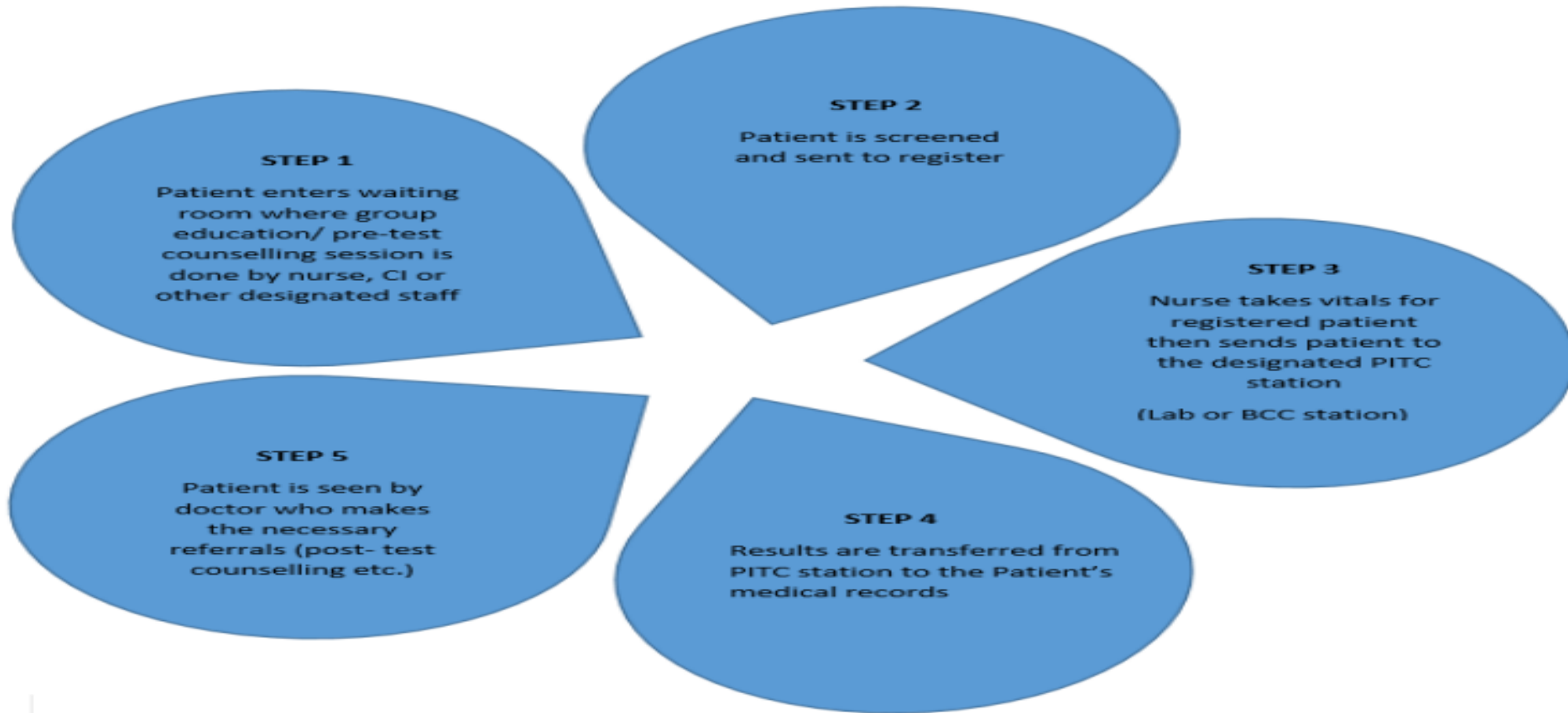
- Nurses
- Doctors
- BCC Officers and Community Peer Educators
- Community Health Aides
- Contact Investigators (CI)

Target Groups

- Antenatal Clinic attendees
- STI Clinic attendees
- Family Planning Clinic attendees
- Infectious Disease patients
- Inmates and other clients from closed settings
- Men
- Youth 16-24 years
- Female curative clinic attendees aged 25-45 years

PITC Flow Process

PITC Flow



PITC Reporting

Data generated from Health Centre PITC should be included on parish and regional lab reports and on the Treatment Care and Support Officers' report.

PITC	Parish _____								TOTAL	
	Name of Site		Name of Site		Name of Site		Name of Site			
	#	%	#	%	#	%	#	%	#	%
# of visits										
# of tests										
# tested positive for HIV (yield)										

HOSPITALS OFFERING PITC

SERHA	NERHA	SRHA	WRHA
Kingston Public Hospital	St. Ann's Bay Hospital	Mandeville Regional Hospital	Cornwall Regional Hospital
Princess Margret Hospital	Port Maria Hospital	Percy Junior Hospital	Savanna la Mar Public General Hospital
Linstead Hospital	Annotto Bay Hospital	Black River Hospital	Falmouth Hospital
Spanish Town Hospital	Port Antonio Hospital	May Pen Hospital	Noel Holmes Hospital
National Chest Hospital		Lionel Town Hospital	
		Chapelton Community Hospital	

Health Centres Offering PITC

SRHA		
May Pen Health Centre	Mandeville Comprehensive Health Centre	Black River Comprehensive Health Centre

Health Centres Offering PITC

SERHA		
Morant Bay Health Centre	Windward Road Health Centre	Old Harbour Health Centre
Comprehensive Health Centre	Maxfield Park Health Centre	Grants Pens Health Centre
Duhaney Park Health Centre	Linstead Health Centre	St Jago Park Health Centre

Health Centres Offering PITC

NERHA		
Port Maria Health Centre	Retreat Health Centre	Mt Pleasant Health Centre
Highgate Health Centre	Windsor Castle Health Centre	Hope Bay Health Centre
Gayle Health Centre	Belfield Health Centre	Cascade Health Centre
Annotto B Bay Health Centre	Port Antonio Health Centre	St Ann's Bay Health Centre
Islington Health Centre	Buff Bay Health Centre	Browns Town Health Centre
Oracabessa Health Centre	Fellowship Health Centre	Moneague Health Centre
Wood Park Health Centre	Moore Town Health Centre	Ocho Rios Health Centre
Alexandria Health Centre	Claremont Health Centre	

Health Centres Offering PITC

WRHA		
Falmouth Health Centre	Wait-a-Bit Health Centre	Savanna-la-Mar Health Centre
Duncans Health Centre	Warsop Health Centre	Darliston Health Centre
Wakefield Health Centre	Mobay Type V Health Centre	Negril Health Centre
Albert Town Health Centre	Sandy Bay Health Centre	Whitehouse Health Centre
Ultser Spring Health Centre	Hopewell Health Centre	Grange Hill Health Centre
Duanvale Health Centre	Green Island Health Centre	Bethel Town Health Centre
Jackson Town Health Centre	Dias Health Centre	

Any Questions

